Chapter-wise Detailed Notes — Democracy versus economic growth

Introduction to Political Theory · Unit 4 · Chapter Democracy versus economic growth

Assam University · BA FYUGP / NEP 2020 · Semester 1

Chapter Study Notes

Learning focus

The debate asks whether democratic participation and accountability support or obstruct rapid economic growth.

1. Arguments for compatibility stress legitimacy, information flows, peaceful correction of policy mistakes, human-capital investment and constraints on arbitrary government.

2. Arguments about trade-offs point to electoral short-termism, veto points or difficulties implementing unpopular reforms. These effects depend on institutions and context rather than democracy alone.

3. Economic growth is not identical to human development: distribution, public health, education, environmental costs and political freedoms also matter.

4. A balanced assessment compares evidence across countries and avoids assuming that either democracy or authoritarianism guarantees good economic outcomes.

Revision checklist

■ Can I define the key concept in my own words?

■ Can I explain its main features and distinguish it from related concepts?

■ Can I support an argument with a relevant example, thinker or constitutional provision?

■ Can I discuss at least one limitation or counterargument?